

tools are programmed to detect and prohibit pronouns when submitting candidate feedback, encouraging the use of gender-neutral pronouns such as they/them,” says Rao.

Additionally, feedback packets are created without identifiers like name, surname, or ethnicity, ensuring the focus remains solely on skills, qualifications, and experience, she adds.

Google has also been working towards ensuring fair compensation for women globally, making annual equity adjustments since 2017. “Every year we run a rigorous statistical analysis to make sure all new salaries, bonuses and equity awards are fair. We leverage data to make structured decisions and en-

sure that decisions are taken whilst preventing bias and leveraging multiple perspectives,” says Rao.

Google takes into account things that should impact pay, such as role, level, location and performance. “If we find any differences in proposed pay between men and women globally, we make upward adjustments,” she adds.

A key tenet is also how Google prioritises employee well-being and offers flexibility at work. From initiatives such as the option to work from any location outside their primary work location for four weeks a year, to work-from-anywhere in case of extenuating family circumstances for up to 12 weeks in a rolling 12-month period,

Google offers several options. There’s also carers’ leave for each loved one (family member, partners, and dependents) per lifetime for serious and critical illnesses of eight weeks.

“We also offer three months of baby bonding leave for non-birthing parents and work from home of three months for birthing mothers post six months of maternity leave,” says Rao. Google also has a ‘Ramp Back Time’ for returning mums that allow them to work a minimum of 50% of their normal weekly working hours, while still being paid 100% of their normal weekly salary in their first two weeks back at work from maternity leave.

Google also provides equal access and coverage through the India health insurance policy, which is inclusive of all LGBTQ+ identities. Its medical insurance cover includes domestic partners, while there is a Transgender Healthcare Program that supports Googlers and their dependents who are transitioning by helping them find doctors, navigate the healthcare system, pay for treatment, and more.

Google has also adopted a hybrid approach to work as it expects most employees to spend approximately three days in the office and two days wherever they work best.

The company also offers opportunities to employees to apply for completely remote work based on their respective roles and teams’ needs. All these measures have contributed to Google India being a regular among the top companies in the *BT-Taggd* survey of The Best Companies to Work For in India in recent years. **BT**

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Key HR initiatives

▶ Full-time employees can dedicate up to 20% of their time to side projects of their choice

▶ Grant of \$3,500 per year for eligible employees to undergo training courses

▶ Flexibility to work from outside office, if required, for a stipulated period every year; ‘Ramp Back Time’ for returning mums

▶ Annual equity adjustments since 2017 to ensure fair

compensation for women globally

▶ Health insurance policy inclusive of all LGBTQ+ identities; medical insurance covers domestic partners; Transgender Healthcare Program